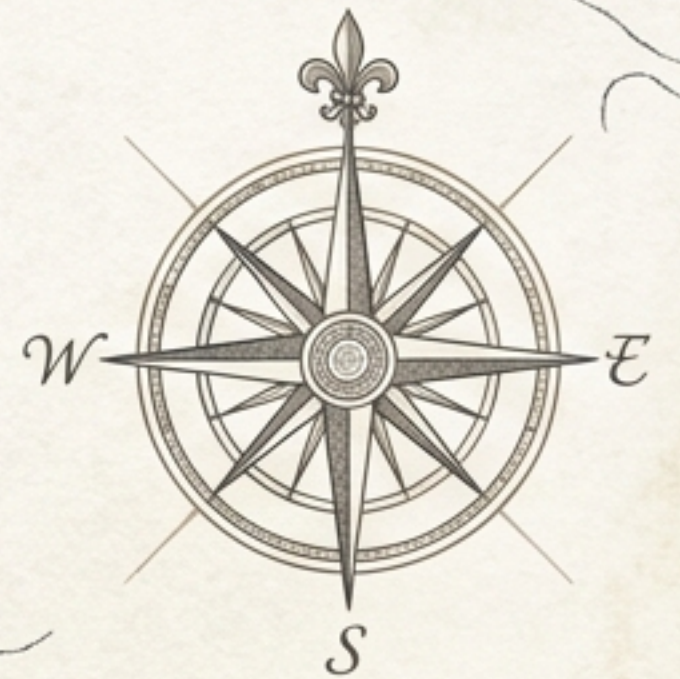


The Architecture of Victory

Strategy, Ruin, and the Final Phase
of the American Civil War



The Strategic Chokehold of July 1863

The Eastern Theater: Gettysburg

General Lee's northern advance halted by Union General Meade after three days of fighting.

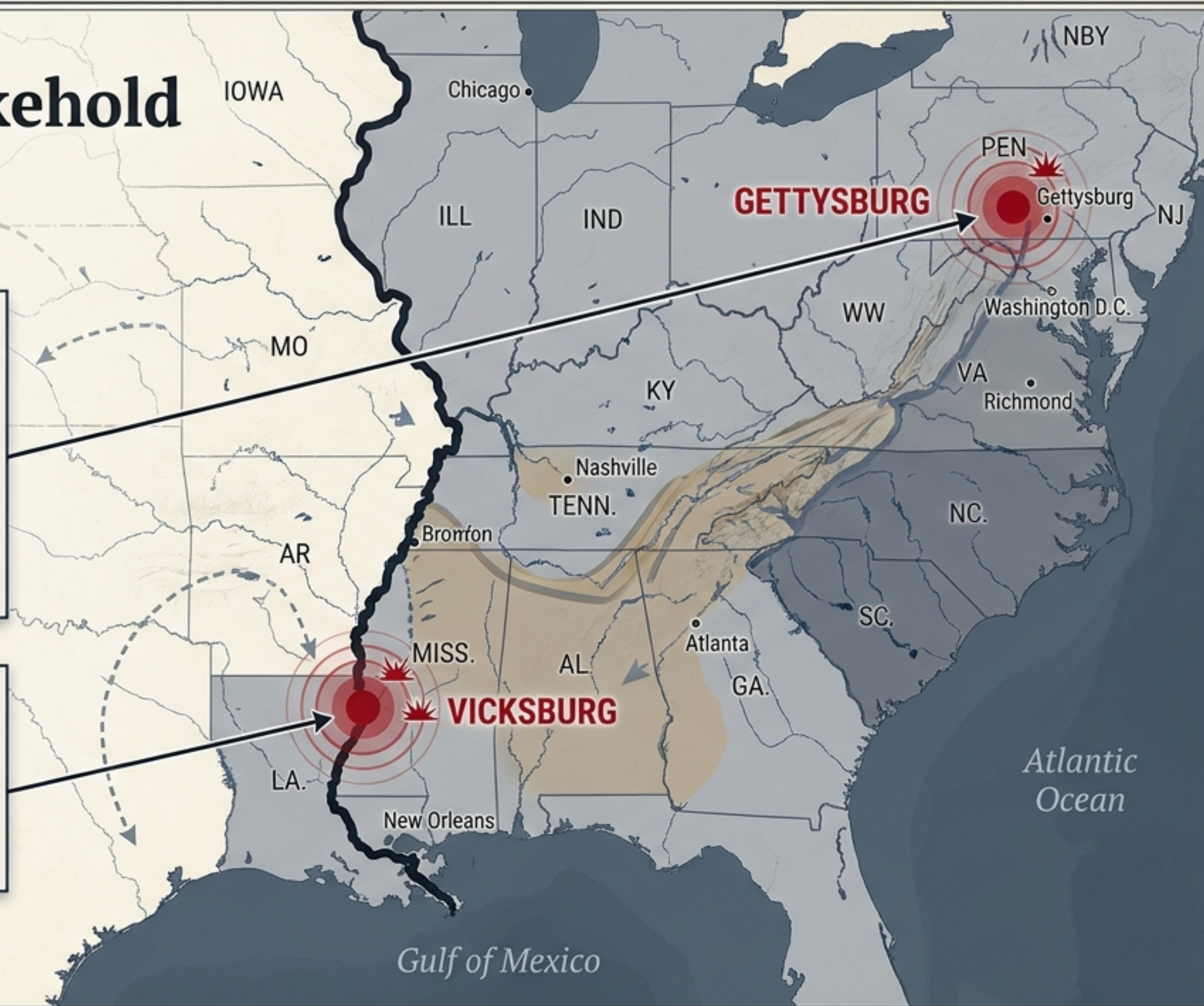
Casualties:

South: **28,000** lost

North: **23,000** lost

The Western Theater: Vicksburg

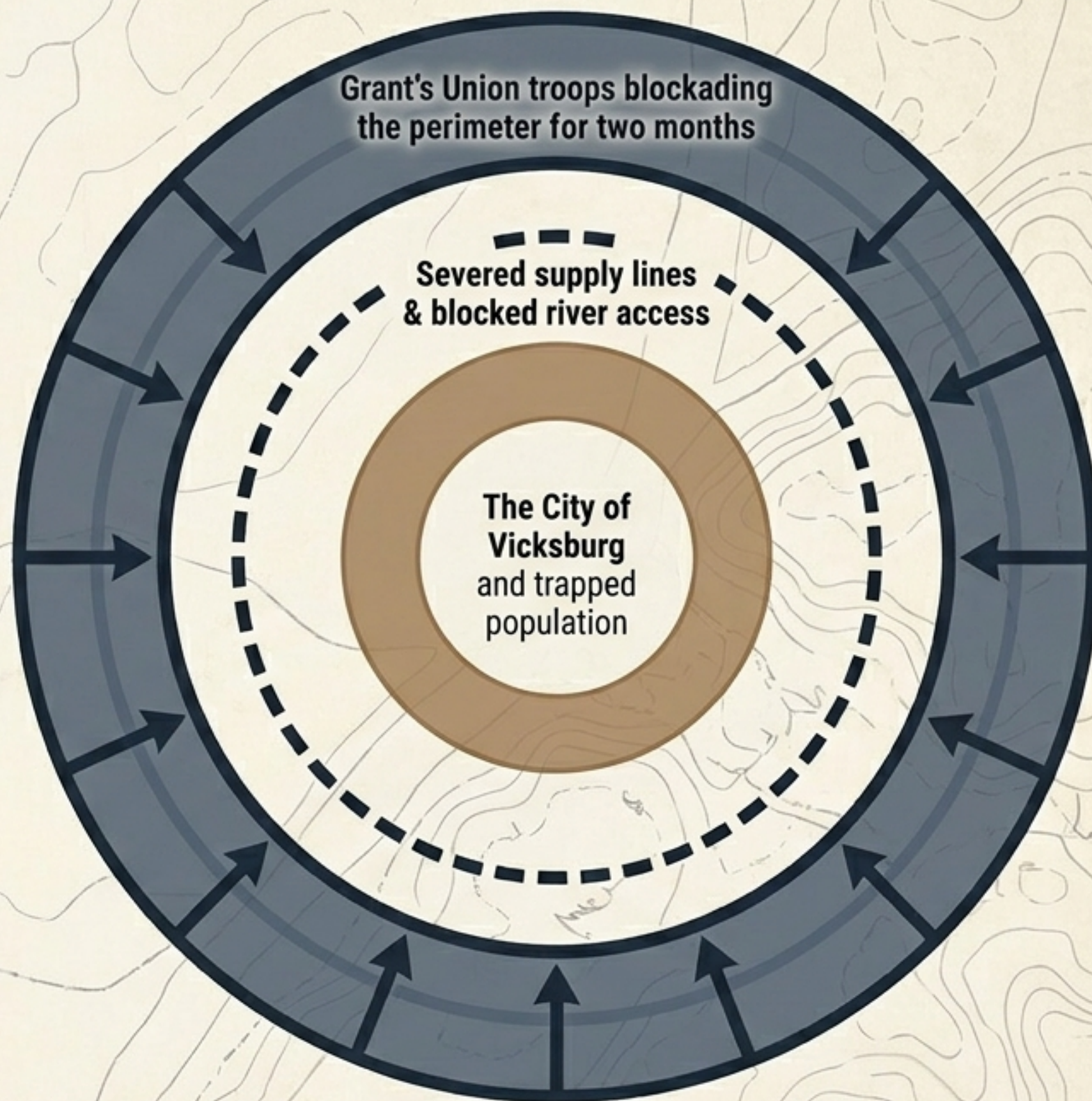
General Grant secures the final Confederate stronghold on the Mississippi River, permanently severing the South's western supply line.



The Anatomy of a Siege at Vicksburg

Siege [noun]:

An attempt to capture a place by surrounding it with troops and cutting it off until its people surrender.



A New Birth of Freedom

● November 19, 1863

*“All men are created equal...
... the nation shall have a
a new birth of freedom.”*

President Lincoln dedicates the Gettysburg cemetery, transforming the battlefield into an ideological mandate for the nation's future.

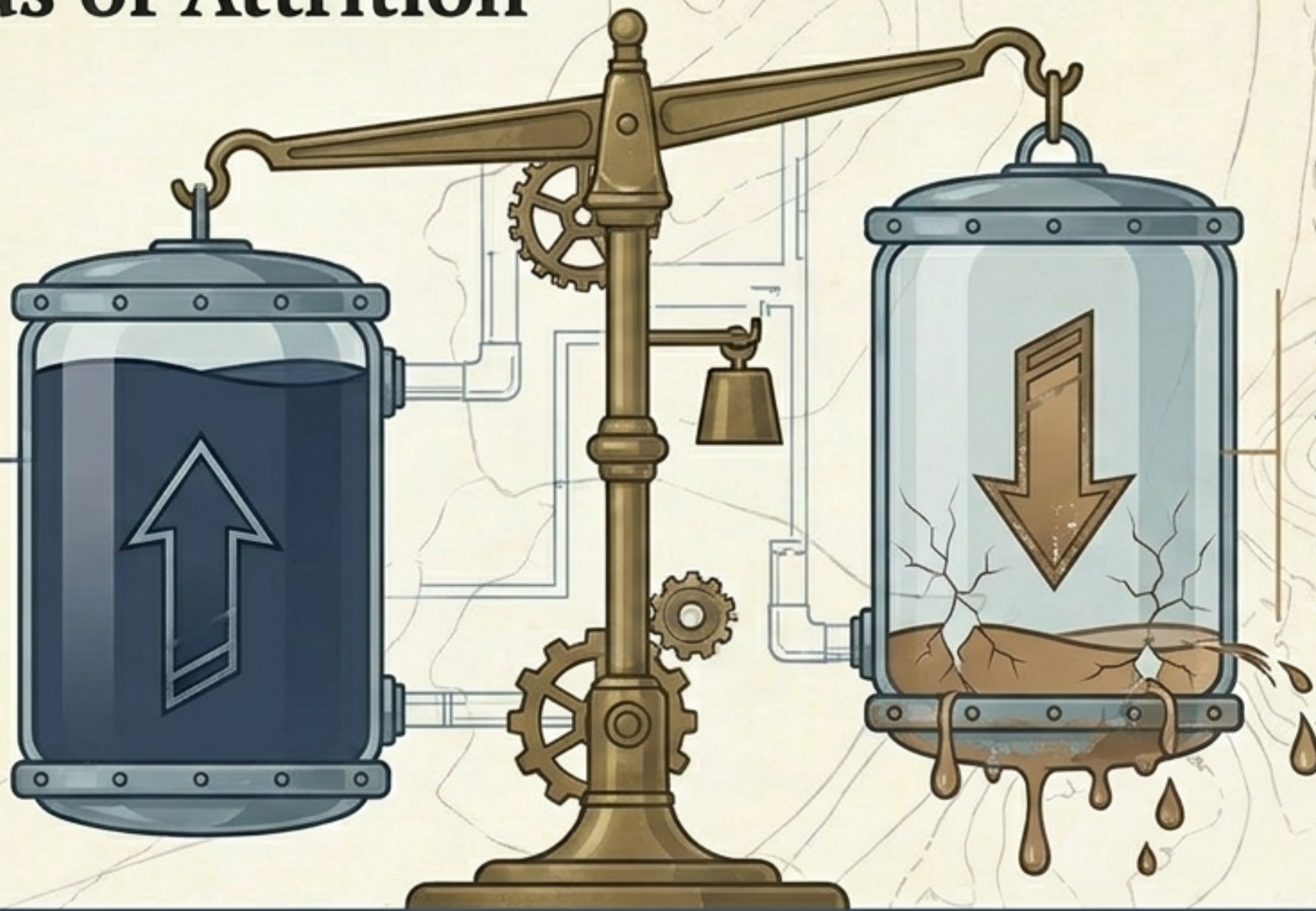
The Evolution of Union Command: Grant vs. Sherman

	General Grant	General William Tecumseh Sherman
 Primary Theater	Virginia & The East	Deep South & Georgia
 Strategic Objective	Defeat Lee's Army	Destroy the Confederacy's capacity to wage war
 Tactical Doctrine	Attrition Leveraging superior Northern numbers against dwindling Southern supplies.	Total War All-out attacks aimed at destroying resources.
 Target Scope	Strict focus on military targets	Military targets plus economic and civilian resources

The Calculus of Attrition

The Union War Machine

A deep, replenishing reservoir of soldiers. Grant accepted heavy losses because he knew his men could be replaced.



The Confederate War Machine

A draining, finite pool of soldiers and materiel. The South was permanently running out of fighting men and supplies.

Spring 1864: As Grant marched toward Richmond through a series of bloody battles, he utilized brutal mathematical logic to grind down the Southern army.

The Mechanics of Total War

Atlanta
(Captured Sept 2, 1864)

Total war targets not just the enemy's army, but its entire societal foundation.

1. Destroy Resources

Set fire to buildings, seize crops and livestock.

2. Break Infrastructure

Pull up railroad tracks, halt supply chains.

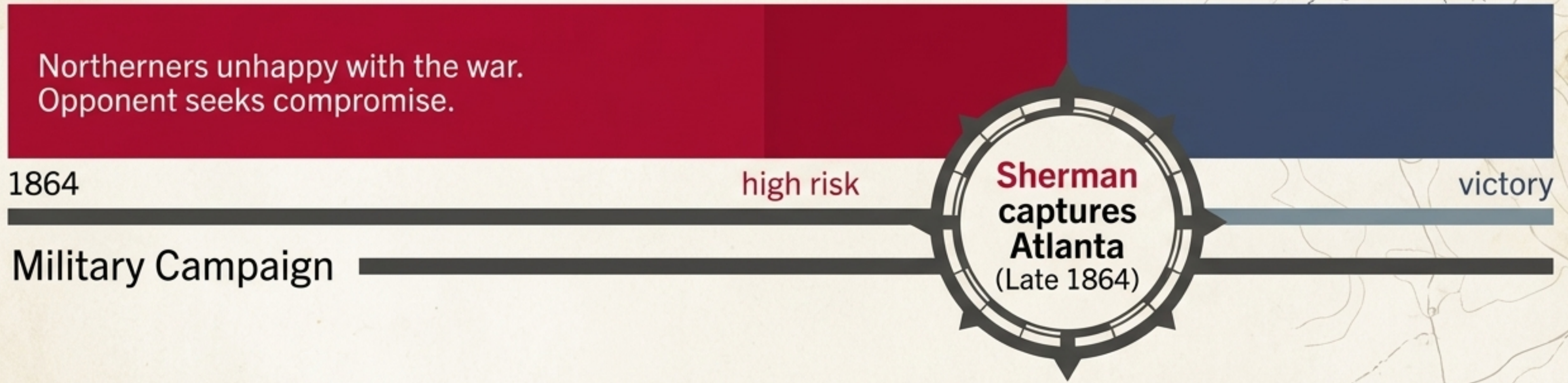
3. Crush Civilian Will

Eliminate the population's desire and ability to support the fighting force.

The Atlantic Ocean

Victory as Political Capital

Political Homefront: Lincoln's Reelection



Facing a populace weary of war and an opponent pushing for compromise with the Confederacy, Lincoln believed he would lose the 1864 election. Late-year military victories provided the undeniable proof of progress needed to secure his second term.

The Anaconda Squeeze

March 1865:
Grant extends his armies,
completely encircling Lee.
The spatial trap is set.

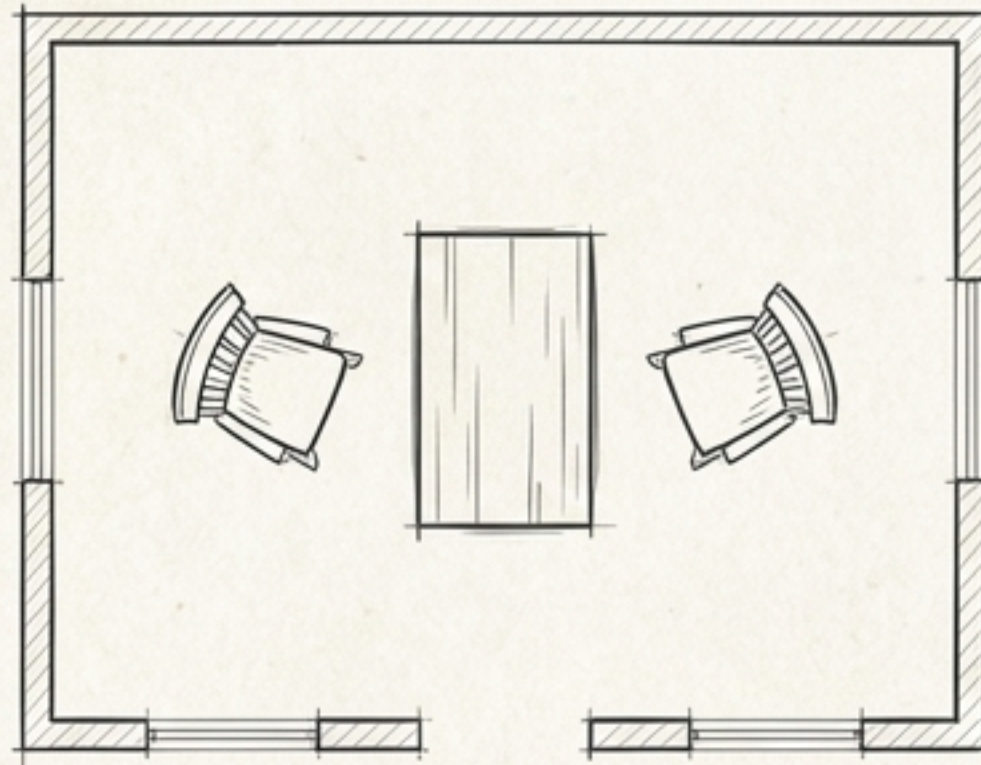
Lee's Forces

Richmond

April 2, 1865:
The Confederate line
breaks. Richmond (the
capital) is captured.
Lee is forced into a brief
western retreat.

The Surrender at Appomattox

● April 9, 1865 — Appomattox Court House, Virginia



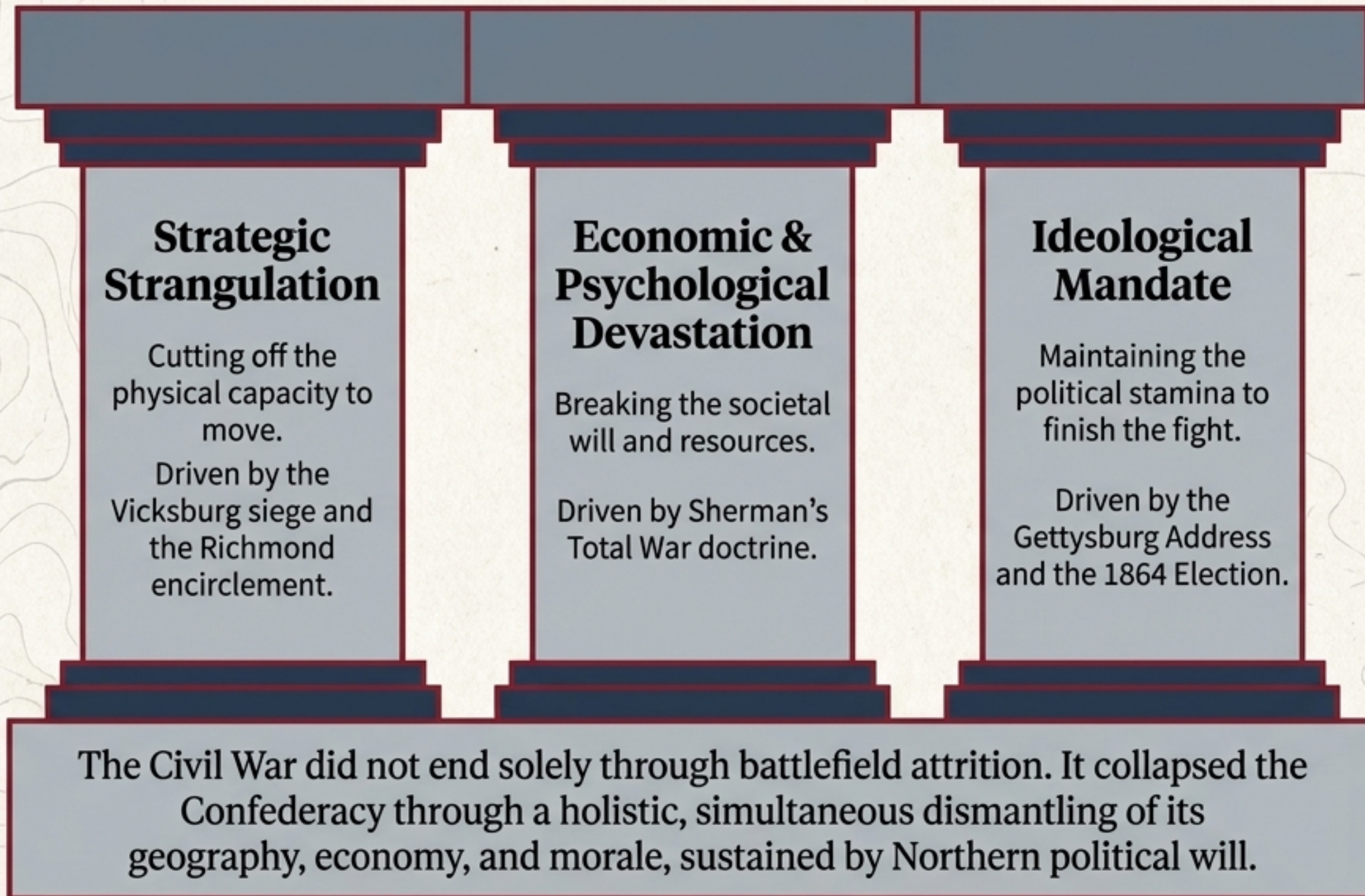
Grant and Lee meet to sign the surrender. In a crucial mandate for postwar reconciliation, the Union generously allows Confederate soldiers to return home without punishment.

Binding the Nation's Wounds

Knowing the military war was won, Lincoln shifts his ultimate command to the American people: welcome the South back into the Union.

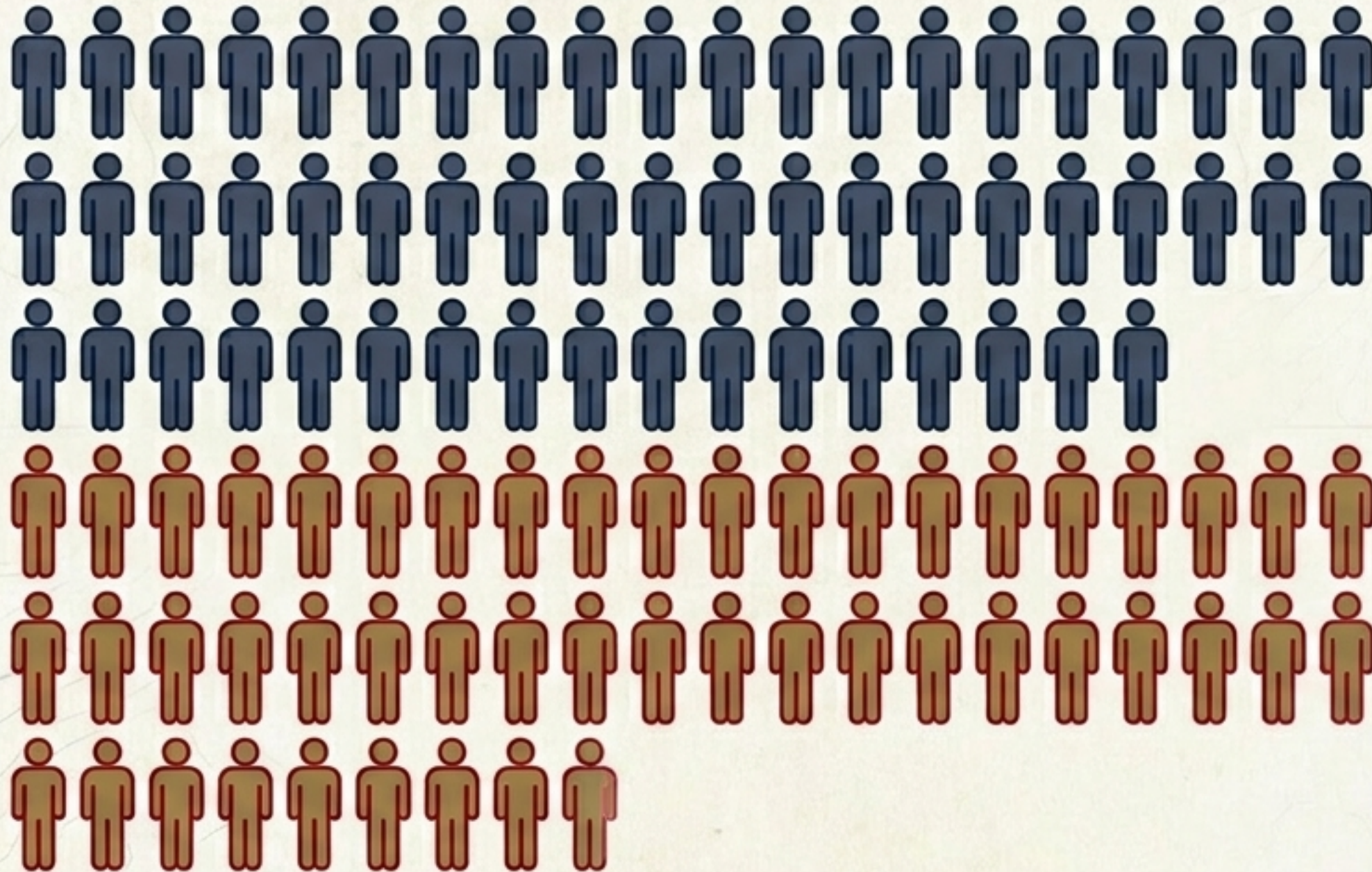
With malice
toward none,
with charity for
all... let us
strive together
to bind up the
nation's wounds.

The Architecture of Victory



The Ultimate Toll

1 figure = 10,000 lives lost



>360,000
Northern dead

250,000
Southern dead

The war was over, the Union preserved, and freedom redefined. But the effects of over 610,000 lives lost would echo through the nation long after the guns fell silent.